title: "Environmental Cleaning Policy" effectiveDate: "" reviewDate: "" version: "1.0"

Environmental Cleaning Policy

Policy Title: Environmental Cleaning Policy

Effective Date: [Insert Date]

Review Date: [Insert Date – usually annually]

Version: 1.0

Applies to: All staff, agency workers, contractors, and visitors at [INSERT CARE HOME NAME]

1. Policy Statement

At [INSERT CARE HOME NAME], we are committed to maintaining a clean, safe, and hygienic environment to protect residents, staff, and visitors from infection risks and to promote dignity and wellbeing. Effective cleaning and hygiene practices are a vital part of infection prevention and control (IPC) and support compliance with statutory and regulatory requirements.

We aim to:

- Ensure high standards of cleanliness across all areas of the home
- Minimise the risk of cross-infection through effective cleaning procedures
- Provide a safe, welcoming, and comfortable environment for residents
- Comply with health and safety and infection control legislation

2. Purpose

This policy sets out:

- Standards and procedures for environmental cleaning
- Roles and responsibilities of staff in maintaining hygiene
- Guidance on cleaning methods, schedules, and record keeping
- Measures to manage infection risks, including during outbreaks

3. Scope

This policy applies to:

- All areas of the care home including bedrooms, communal spaces, bathrooms, kitchens, offices, and external areas
- All staff with cleaning responsibilities, including care, domestic, catering, and maintenance teams

- Contractors providing cleaning or waste management services

4. Roles and Responsibilities

Registered Manager:

- Ensures environmental cleaning policies and procedures are in place
- Provides resources, equipment, and training for staff
- Monitors compliance through audits and inspections

Domestic / Cleaning Staff:

- Carry out cleaning tasks in line with agreed schedules and procedures
- Use appropriate cleaning products, PPE, and equipment safely
- Complete cleaning records and report any issues immediately

All Staff:

- Maintain good standards of cleanliness in their work areas
- Support infection prevention by following cleaning protocols (e.g., spills, shared equipment)
- Report hazards or unclean areas promptly

5. Key Cleaning Standards and Procedures

5.1 General Cleaning

- Daily cleaning of resident rooms, bathrooms, and communal areas
- Regular cleaning of high-touch surfaces (door handles, handrails, switches)
- Use of colour-coded equipment to prevent cross-contamination

5.2 Bathrooms and Toilets

- Cleaned and disinfected at least daily and after heavy use
- Dedicated cleaning equipment must be used for these areas only

5.3 Kitchens and Food Preparation Areas

- Cleaned and sanitised before and after food preparation
- Food hygiene standards must be strictly followed in line with HACCP principles
- Fridges, freezers, and storage areas cleaned regularly and recorded

5.4 Resident Bedrooms

- Cleaned daily, with bed linen changed in line with schedules or when soiled
- Personal items handled respectfully and with consent
- Deep cleaning carried out on resident discharge or after infection

5.5 Spillages and Body Fluids

- Must be cleaned immediately using appropriate disinfectants
- Staff must use PPE and dispose of waste safely
- Incident must be recorded

5.6 Waste Disposal

- Waste segregated into domestic and clinical waste streams
- Sharps disposed of in approved sharps containers

- Waste bins emptied daily and cleaned regularly

5.7 Outbreak Situations

- Enhanced cleaning protocols implemented immediately
- Increased frequency of cleaning for high-touch areas
- Use of approved disinfectants in line with Public Health guidance

6. Equipment and Supplies

- Cleaning products must be approved for use in healthcare environments
- PPE (gloves, aprons, masks where required) must be worn during cleaning
- Cleaning equipment must be maintained, replaced when worn, and stored safely

7. Training and Education

- Staff involved in cleaning will receive training in:
    - Infection prevention and control (IPC)
    - Safe use of cleaning chemicals (COSHH)
    - Colour-coding systems and cross-contamination prevention
- Training records will be maintained and refreshed annually

8. Monitoring and Audit

- Cleaning schedules and records must be completed daily
- Regular audits and inspections carried out by managers
- Resident and family feedback considered as part of quality assurance
- Non-compliance or poor standards will result in corrective action

9. References

- Health and Social Care Act 2008 (Regulated Activities) Regulations 2014
- CQC Fundamental Standards – Regulation 12 (Safe Care and Treatment)
- NHS / UKHSA Infection Prevention and Control Guidance
- COSHH (Control of Substances Hazardous to Health) Regulations 2002

10. Related Policies

- Infection Prevention & Control Policy
- Waste Management Policy
- Health and Safety Policy
- Staff Training & Development Policy
- Outbreak Management Policy

Generated by Docuflow